



## Summary

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William Ernest Henley's poem "Invictus" features a speaker who declares himself the master of his own destiny. In the first stanza, he thanks the gods for his undefeatable soul, which helps him deal with the dark night that surrounds him. No matter the circumstance, the speaker does not cry. Though he has been bloodied, he is not fearful and keeps his head upright. In the third and fourth stanzas, the speaker refers to the horrors of his current time and place. Still, he moves forward unafraid. In the final lines of the poem, he states that he is the master of his own fate and the commander of his soul.

## Read

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- 1 Out of the night that covers me,
- 2 Black as the pit from pole to pole,
- 3 I thank whatever gods may be
- 4 For my unconquerable soul.
  
- 5 In the **fell** clutch of circumstance
- 6 I have not winced nor cried aloud.
- 7 Under the **bludgeonings** of chance
- 8 My head is bloody, but unbowed.
  
- 9 Beyond this place of wrath and tears
- 10 **Looms** but the horror of the **shade**,
- 11 And yet the menace of the years
- 12 Finds, and shall find, me unafraid.
  
- 13 It matters not how **strait** the gate,
- 14 How charged with punishments the scroll,
- 15 I am the master of my fate:
- 16 I am the captain of my soul.

## Annotations

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